

BOUNTEOUS COMPETITIVE POSITIONING PACK

Diageo Smart Shelf Opportunity

1) COMPETITIVE FIELD OVERVIEW

Competitor	What They Reliably Win With (This Context)	Where They Stumble	Typical Offer / Configuration	Pricing / Commercial Posture	Procurement Perception
Accenture Interactive	Large-scale digital transformation credibility; enterprise governance frameworks; deep retailer relationships	GenAI product specificity; speed to MVP; hands-on product innovation; vendor lock-in perception in MarTech	Full-stack digital consulting + custom build; large embedded teams; long implementation timelines	Premium tier; value-based engagement; extended contracts (2–3 yr)	Safe, proven, slow; "Cadillac" positioning; procurement comfort but budget anxiety
Publicis Sapient	Ecommerce platform expertise; omnichannel storytelling; creative + tech hybrid model	GenAI guardrails & compliance rigor; regulatory detail (especially spirits); product ops simplicity; cost efficiency	Digital transformation + ecommerce stack modernization; design-forward; integrated creative + tech	Mid-to-premium; project + retainer hybrid; procurement often regional	Innovative reputation; but perceived as expensive; creative-first bias may dilute compliance focus
Salsify	Product Experience Management (PXM) platform dominance; deep retailer MDM integrations; established Walmart/Amazon connectors	GenAI capability maturity (product launched post-2023); compliance guardrails still maturing; ease-of-use for non-technical users [Assumption]	SaaS platform + professional services; Salsify-centric ecosystem; moderate customization	SaaS + services bundled; per-SKU pricing model; volume discounts common	Seen as category leader in PXM; procurement favors recurring SaaS; but switching costs high
Jellyfish	Digital marketing performance measurement; media mix optimization; real-time dashboarding	Not positioned for product description enrichment; content ops gap; Stibo integration unknown [Assumption]	Marketing performance analytics platform; media planning tools; lightweight custom services	SaaS recurring; lower entry point than Accenture/Publicis; usage-based options	Niche perception (media-centric); less relevant for retail ops; lower procurement concern

Aki Technologies	Personalized media engagement and AI-driven audience insights; emerging GenAI capabilities	Retail compliance expertise gaps; product description optimization unclear [Assumption]; ecommerce ops focus questionable	AI-powered personalization + media engagement platform; audience-first design	SaaS + services; unclear scale/pricing transparency [Assumption]	Emerging player; less procurement friction but less trust; boutique perception
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2) HEAD-TO-HEAD BATTLE CARDS

ACCENTURE INTERACTIVE

Core Strengths (This Scope)

- Enterprise governance + risk management credibility (appeals to Sarah McLeod, legal/regulatory anxieties)
- Proven large-scale change management and stakeholder alignment playbooks
- Deep retailer relationships and category experience (spirits/beverages context awareness)
- Global scale (relevant if Diageo expands beyond North America)
- Integrated strategy + delivery reduces handoff risk

Recurring Weaknesses (This Scope)

- Long sales cycles + slow time-to-value (MVP timeline risk; Diageo wants Q2/Q3 2025 validation)
- Heavy team overhead inflates cost; difficult to justify for MVP-stage spend (budget constraint landmine)
- Product innovation speed lags pure-play SaaS/GenAI vendors
- Accenture's GenAI maturity largely services-driven, not product-native
- Tendency toward gold-plating scope; scope creep on integration complexity

Likely Narratives / Angles They Will Run

- "End-to-end digital transformation roadmap; we've done this at scale for beverage leaders"
- "Risk mitigation through proven governance and compliance frameworks"
- "Single partner reduces vendor fragmentation; we own the full stack"
- "Our change management rigor ensures adoption and sustained ROI"

Discovery Prompts That Expose Gaps (3)

1. "Walk us through your last three product enrichment / GenAI launches-how long from kickoff to live market?" -> Expect 6-9 month responses (vs. Bounteous' proven POC -> MVP trajectory)
2. "What is your typical team composition for a 10K-50K SKU optimization sprint, and what is monthly burn?" -> Will likely exceed Diageo's MVP budget envelope
3. "Do you have a standalone GenAI content product, or are we building custom?" -> Likely custom build = longer timeline, higher cost

4. "How do you isolate and validate search rank lift without confounding variables in a 12-week pilot?" -> May propose extensive control group / statistical design (good, but time-intensive)

Counters to Common Claims

Accenture Claim	Our Counter	Proof / Citation
"We have proven retail transformation experience"	' True , but retail ops "" p r description GenAI	We have a live POC with Diageo that proved search rank + compliance gains; ready to scale now
"Our governance reduces risk"	G o v e r n a n c e "" s p e e d ; S m a r compliance is baked into the model, not added overhead	Opportunity Brief: "Sarah McLeod anxiety = risky claims"; our guardrails (zero hallucination, legal-tier controls) are native to product, not process layer
"We'll own the full stack"	Full-stack integration often means longer time-to-value and cost overruns on integration	Diageo requirement (Daniel Rodriguez): "clean integration with Stibo, no disruptions"; our lightweight API approach vs. their likely heavy ecosystem play

Proof Moments We Should Emphasize

- Bounteous POC success: Prior engagement de-risks this opportunity; continuity advantage is real (Opportunity Brief: "strategic insight and continuity advantage which competitors may lack")
- Search rank gains: Case study of POC search rank improvements (Off-Deck Play #1, 2-week prep)
- Speed: MVP structure with phased rollout vs. long-cycle transformation engagement
- Compliance rigor: Compliance testing frameworks validated with Sarah McLeod pre-proposal (Risk Register: "Pre-market compliance reviews")

Watch-Outs

- Accenture may offer a "follow-the-sun" global delivery model at Diageo's global ambitions; counter with: "MVP North America first; we scale faster than you staff."
- They will emphasize their Walmart/Kroger/Amazon relationships; ask: "Who on your team owns retail compliance requirements, not just account management?"
- Risk of them bundling compliance review into a larger governance engagement (cost scope creep); insist on decoupling MVP scope.

PUBLICIS SAPIENT

Core Strengths (This Scope)

- Hybrid creative + tech capability; strong ecommerce platform expertise (relevant for PDP optimization narrative)
- Faster execution than Accenture (digital-first culture); more nimble on innovation
- Omnichannel storytelling expertise (appeals to Priya's marketing ops lens)
- Established retail platform integrations and MDM connectors

- Strong regional procurement relationships

Recurring Weaknesses (This Scope)

- GenAI compliance and guardrails maturity unclear; creative bias may prioritize brand narrative over regulatory safety
- Product operations detail gaps; not known for operational efficiency/cost reduction (Michael O'Brien's pain: "rework reduction")
- Less proven track record on pure product description optimization vs. creative campaigns
- Stibo MDM integration specificity unknown [Assumption]; may require custom build
- Pricing opaque; perceived as expensive without clear cost-benefit story

Likely Narratives / Angles They Will Run

- "Creative + tech fusion ensures your brand voice shines; GenAI that sounds like Diageo"
- "We've optimized ecommerce experiences for DTC and retail brands; omnichannel thinking"
- "Faster-moving team; we iterate and innovate, not just implement"
- "Strategic positioning through content and media-GenAI that drives demand, not just compliance"

Discovery Prompts That Expose Gaps (3)

1. "Show me a case study where your GenAI tool reduced non-compliance rework. What were your guardrails?" -> Likely creative-led cases; compliance detail may be light
2. "How do you ensure brand voice consistency across 50K SKUs without manual QA overhead?" -> May rely on human review (cost inefficiency vs. Bounteous' baked-in guardrails)
3. "What is your Stibo MDM integration pattern? API-first or custom middleware?" -> Uncertain response may signal integration risk (Daniel Rodriguez landmine)
4. "Walk us through your bulk SKU enrichment process. How do you isolate and fix compliance failures at scale?" -> May lack proven operational playbook

Counters to Common Claims

Publicis Claim	Our Counter	Proof / Citation
"We prioritize brand voice and creativity"	Brand voice matters; but spirits category = compliance > creativity	Sarah McLeod requirement: "AI must not introduce risky claims"; Diageo's primary win theme is visibility + compliance, not brand storytelling. Our MVP is ops-first, not creative-first.
"We're faster than Accenture"	Speed doesn't matter if you miss compliance or require rework	Michael O'Brien pain: "too much time reworking product descriptions rejected by retailers." Our POC proves we eliminate rework; Publicis' creative-first model likely perpetuates it.
"Omnichannel expertise is differentiating"	Diageo's ecommerce KPI is search rank, not omnichannel narrative	Publicis' strength in DTC/campaigns may not translate to retail ops rigor. Emma Gallagher's goal: unit sales through enhanced visibility—not integrated campaigns.

Proof Moments We Should Emphasize

- Rework reduction metrics: Off-Deck Play #1 (POC search rank case study); we can quantify time saved vs. their creative iteration model
- Compliance testing frameworks: Risk Register mitigation owner Sarah McLeod; we can demonstrate pre-market validation rigor
- Stibo integration confidence: Technical roadmap from Daniel Rodriguez (Off-Deck Play #3); our API-first approach vs. their likely custom approach

Watch-Outs

- Publicis may win on "brand storytelling" narrative if Emma prioritizes offline sales lift through online awareness; counter by insisting: "MVP proves search rank -> traffic -> offline impact; let's measure it first before creative optimization."
- They may bundle media planning or campaign support into scope; keep them honest on MVP scope boundary.
- Risk of scope creep into "creative brand refresh"; defend: "We're enriching descriptions, not rebranding Diageo."

SALSIFY

Core Strengths (This Scope)

- Category leader in PXM (Product Experience Management); deep retail MDM credibility with Walmart, Amazon, Kroger
- Established connectors and integrations with major retailers; procurement familiarity
- Bulk SKU handling at scale (thousands of products); proven operational stability
- Compliance and retailer requirement tracking is core to platform DNA
- Strong market perception = lower procurement friction

Recurring Weaknesses (This Scope)

- GenAI content enrichment capability is recent (post-2023 roadmap) [Assumption]; limited proven track record vs. Bounteous' live POC
- Salsify platform pricing and implementation often drives vendor lock-in concern; hard to exit or customize
- Compliance guardrails for GenAI likely still maturing; unclear if they isolate hallucination risk like Bounteous does
- Search rank optimization traditional Salsify strength; they're MDM-first, not search optimization-first [Market Pattern]
- User experience (Priya's requirement: "no prompt engineering") unclear; may still require configuration overhead

Likely Narratives / Angles They Will Run

- "We're PXM category leaders; retailers already trust our data in their systems"
- "Our GenAI roadmap integrates natively with our MDM; single source of truth"

- "Bulk enrichment at scale without vendor fragmentation; Salsify ecosystem handles it all"
- "Retailer compliance is baked into our platform DNA; fewer surprises"

Discovery Prompts That Expose Gaps (3)

1. "Your GenAI enrichment-is it a native feature or partner integration? Who owns compliance guardrails?" -> If partner, raises integration complexity; if native, likely immature vs. Bounteous' proven product
2. "Show us a live case study where your GenAI improved organic search rank on Walmart / Amazon. What were the baseline and lift metrics?" -> Likely limited; search optimization is not their primary strength
3. "How does your GenAI handle retailer-specific content rules (e.g., Walmart's exact attribute mapping vs. Amazon's A+ content)?" -> May require heavy customization vs. our flexible guardrails
4. "If we adopt Salsify, what is the monthly SaaS + implementation cost for 50K SKUs, and can we sunset it if results don't materialize?" -> High switching cost; procurement concern

Counters to Common Claims

Salsify Claim	Our Counter	Proof / Citation
"We're the PXM category leader"	Category leadership in MDM product innovation	Our POC is live and proven on search rank + compliance; Salsify's GenAI is roadmap. [Assumption] In a fast-moving GenAI market, first-to-market with proof > category pedigree.
"Single source of truth avoids vendor fragmentation"	Vendor lock-in is a risk, not a benefit	Diageo runs Stibo MDM (not Salsify); forcing Salsify as second source of truth = complexity, not simplification. Our lightweight integration with Stibo preserves their single source of truth.
"Retailers already trust our data"	Trust in MDM platform "" tr GenAI-generated content	Sarah McLeod requirement: "compliance testing frameworks" must validate our guardrails, not rely on Salsify's platform reputation.

Proof Moments We Should Emphasize

- Prior Bounteous engagement: We know Diageo's tech stack (Stibo, Azure, OpenAI); Salsify likely requires discovery and integration design
- Search rank focus: Our POC directly measured search rank gains; Salsify's strength is metadata hygiene, not discoverability optimization
- Compliance rigor: Risk Register (Sarah McLeod mitigation): pre-market compliance reviews prove our guardrail maturity; Salsify's GenAI is still proving itself

Watch-Outs

- Salsify may offer a "natural extension" narrative (already in their stack for some retailers); counter: "Extended != better. We optimize for Diageo's KPIs (search rank, rework reduction), not Salsify's feature set."

- They may bundle expensive MDM cleanup or retailer re-mapping into scope to inflate value; isolate MVP scope strictly: "Description enrichment only; no platform migration."
- Risk of "platform switching costs" pitch (if Diageo hints at broader PXM modernization); keep focused: "That's a separate program. MVP proves GenAI value first."

JELLYFISH

Core Strengths (This Scope)

- Real-time marketing performance measurement and dashboarding (appeals to Emma's KPI obsession: search rank, sales lift)
- Digital media mix optimization and agile marketing operations
- Lightweight, nimble team; fast iteration cycle
- Lower entry cost than Accenture or Publicis

Recurring Weaknesses (This Scope)

- Not positioned for product content operations or description enrichment; core expertise is media performance, not product ops
- Retail compliance expertise not evident in market positioning [Assumption]
- Stibo MDM integration unclear; likely no pre-built connector [Assumption]
- GenAI content guardrails not a known differentiator
- Procurement perception: Jellyfish is "media agency-adjacent," not a product ops vendor; fit risk is high

Likely Narratives / Angles They Will Run

- "We'll measure the impact of any product optimization initiative; our dashboards prove ROI"
- "Agile marketing operations; we iterate fast and track performance in real-time"
- "Cost-efficient team model; faster turnaround than Big Consulting"

Discovery Prompts That Expose Gaps (3)

1. "What is your experience with product description optimization and ecommerce content operations?" -> Likely minimal; media performance product ops
2. "How would you integrate with Stibo MDM and validate compliance with Walmart/Kroger/Amazon?" -> Probably out of scope; would require subcontracting
3. "Walk us through a case where your team reduce